Starman's Business Guidebook

Jeffield Jefferson, MBA

Jesse H. Jones Graduate School of Executive Management

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This publication contains the opinions and ideas of its author(s) and is designed to provide useful advice in regard to the subject matter covered.

Content



PART ONE: EVALUATING THE BUSINESS

1. Deciding on a Business and Business Name
2. Formatting and Developing a Business Plan

PART TWO: BEFORE YOU START

3. Financing the Business
4. Business Organization
5. Licenses and Permits
6. Business Insurance
7. Communication Tools
8. Buying a Business or Franchise

PART THREE: OPERATING PITFALLS

9. Location and Leasing
10. Accounting and Cash Flow
11. E-Commerce
12. Opening and Marketing
13. Managing Employees
14. Expanding and Handling Problems

PART FOUR: THE PHENOMENAL 4 PRINCIPLES

15. Handling Human Relations Variables in Business
16. Be Remarkable – Business Branding & LOGO
17. About the Lecturer and Corporate Instructor

PART FIVE: BUSINESS PRINCIPLES & BUSINESS TYPES

Dedication

To my Mother, Bertha, the Wind Beneath My Wings; Shirley & children Chandra, LaTanya & Jared; my Sister, Bettye; to Nancy Warren, my most competitive class-mate; my brothers, Andrew, Albert & Alton my friends, Gary & Charles Emmott; to my "Banking" confi-dant, Brandon Bridges; to my genius friends, Brenda McKnight & Kenneth Allen; to Cheryle Grant, my brilliant & loyal Administrative Assistant & Debra Lathan, my greatest supporter; to Doug Earle, for his respect; and the late, Dr. James Race, Jr. who believed in my abilities & others.

About the Author



Jeffield A. Jefferson began life 9 August 1943 in Houston, Texas at Jefferson Davis Hospital to the parents of Bertha Harrield and Andrew L. Jefferson, Sr. as World War II was moving to its final stages. At the age of 6, "Jeff" relocated to Crockett, Texas, a rural East Texas city and County Seat of Houston County, rejoining his Mother, the "Wind Beneath His Wings" in 1950. His Mother, along with his Stepfather, Alton Nathaniel, a "Home Builder" and World War I Veteran who taught him "Basic Civil Engineering in Construction, Hydrology and Environmental Principles, nurtured and developed him. "Jeff" began school in the First Grade, joining his first teacher, Ms. Melvina Andrews and continued his formative years of education at Ralph J. Bunche Elementary and High School, graduating Salutatorian of his Class in 1961. With his Mother's persistence, "Jeff" was awarded a College Scholarship to Texas Southern University in Houston, Texas.

Upon completion of his Sophomore year and disappointed with his Degree Plan in Civil Engineering, "Jeff" along with his high school friend, Andrew Long, joined the U. S. Army, completing three (3) years of service and was Honorably Discharged on 13 August 1965. "Jeff" returned to TSU to earn his bachelor's degree and later, completed his MBA Degree program in Executive Management & Technology. "Jeff" began his professional career with Harris County as a Senior Auditor before joining Allstate Insurance Company's Management Development Program as Assistant Controller. "Jeff" took advantage of an opportunity to join Dow Chemical USA, moving to Cleveland, Ohio several years later when Allstate restructured and relocated. Upon receiving a promotion, "Jeff" relocated to San Diego, California where he eventually departed from Dow Chemical to begin a "Free Spirited Adventure as a Tennis Instructor; Snow Skiing; and Catamaran Racing in the Pacific Ocean. Returning to employment in 1981, "Jeff" met and later married Shirley, who relocated to Houston, Texas where he currently resides, raising two children, LaTanya and Jared. "Jeff" has three brothers, Andrew, an Attorney and former District Judge; Albert, a Retiree from ExxonMobil; a Sister, Bettye, a Retired Nurse; and Alton. "Jeff" retired from Executive Management with the City of Houston after a career of more than 20 years in 2017 following employment with Texas Southern University and the Houston Port Authority. "Starman's Business Guide is a culmination of the collection of education and practical experience over 60 years in management, teaching and business practice globally throughout the USA, Asia, Europe and Africa. "Jeff" has received numerous awards, certificates and distinguished honors.

Preface

Starman's (Starting & Managing) is a Reference Book and Guide that outlines and narrates the content and sequential steps for starting, operating, and managing a business.

"Starman's Business Guide" was written for those individuals who aspire to become successful in starting, operating, and managing an identified business entity that from the beginning operations will be sustained with the intent of long-term operation and designed for future generations.

It is my hope that the development of the business will be a true indication of the display of the characteristics of true Leadership. Additionally, a sound approach to motivating others to be inspired by a display of the true model of behavior you want to see from others. Furthermore, you will display the principles for inspiring people to share goals and directions for achieving at the highest level. Lastly, I hope that the reader and user of this Guide will display the perseverance and commitment to regularly communicate and share information to create progress in a World that is constantly changing.

Organization & Introduction of The Starman's Business Guide

"Starman's Business Guide" is organized and formatted in a four (4) Part, outlined, and narrated listing of easy segments of a complete, chronologically designed "listing" of every component for organizing, planning, staffing, actuating, and controlling the formation and development of a business.

The second segment is an easy, readable narration and summation of the complete description of each component of starting, operating and managing a business.

Whether you are a novice, layman, or multi-degreed university graduate, the Starman's Business Guide can/will be a great benefit. Here are several worthy benefits: (1) the content and format will provide a segment-by-segment guide on how to start, operate, and manage a business. (2) The content and outlined format will serve as a reminder and replay every phase provided in a 300-page textbook of management principles, paragraphs, and overviews of each component outlined in the Business Guide. (3) The Business Guide format will save an abundance of time reading and re-reading many pages of paragraphs explaining each phase of starting, operating,and managing a business.

The author of "Starman's Business Guide" wishes you continued success, longevity, and profitability in your business endeavors.

PART ONE: Evaluating the Business

1. Deciding on a business

The most common serious mistake made in business is not picking the right one to begin with. The following provides you with important evaluation techniques.

Characteristics of a Successful Business

Implement a Step-by-Step Approach

- Decide if you really want to be in business
- Decide what business and the best location
- Decide whether to start full-time or moonlight
- Develop a Selection Strategy
- Identify and List Things to Watch Out For
- Suggestions for People in Transition
- Identify the Required Activities
- Complete a Pros & Cons Comparative Evaluation
- Evaluate a Specific Business you have in Mind
- Develop a "For" and "Against" List
- Get completely qualified to operate the business
- Confirm your Decision Time



2. Formatting and Developing Your Business Plan

This key ingredient for a successful business is too often skipped. This overview will show you how to create your own individualized business plan and provide the tools to make it easy.

What is a Business Plan?

- Why prepare a business plan?
- What to avoid in your business plan

Business Plan Format

- Develop a Mission and Vision statement.
- Select people for your Management Team
- Format your business profile
- Make an Economic assessment of business.

Six Steps to a Great Business Plan

- Basic business concept - Executive Summary
- Feasibility and specifics
- Focus and refine your business concept
- Outline the specifics of your business
- Put your plan into a compelling format
- Review sample plans

Does Your Plan Include the Following Necessary Factors?

- Summation of a sound business concept
- Provide an understanding of your market.
- Healthy, growing, and stable industry
- Staff of Capable management
- Able financial control
- Consistent business focus

Formation and Development of Your Business Plan

- Mindset to anticipate change
- Plans for online business
- Formulate (and Reformulate) Your Business Plan

Review an Actual Business Plan and Corporate Articles of Incorporation.



PART TWO: Before You Start

3. Financing the Business

Steps to locate, negotiate, and maintain sources of funding to get you started and help you build and develop your business.

How Much Money Do You Need?

- Why do you need it?
- Is there a need for Unsecured Loans?
- Is there a need for Secured Loans?
- Do you have sufficient Collateral?

Loans (Debt) vs. Investment (Equity)

Where to Get Money

- Identify Types of Funding Sources
- Review Lender Comparison Tables

The Art of Getting Money

- Business Loans
- Repayment Plan
- Other Quick Tips

After You Get Money



4. Business Organization

These steps will clearly spell out your options for deciding the form of business that is right for you.

Decisions that every businessperson must make.

1. Whether to go into business alone or with a partner.

2. What type of business organization to use for the sole proprietorship, partnership, corporation or limited liability company(LLC).

3. What professional advisors to select.

Should You Have a Partner?

- Arguments For
- Arguments Against

What Type of Business Organization Is Best for You?

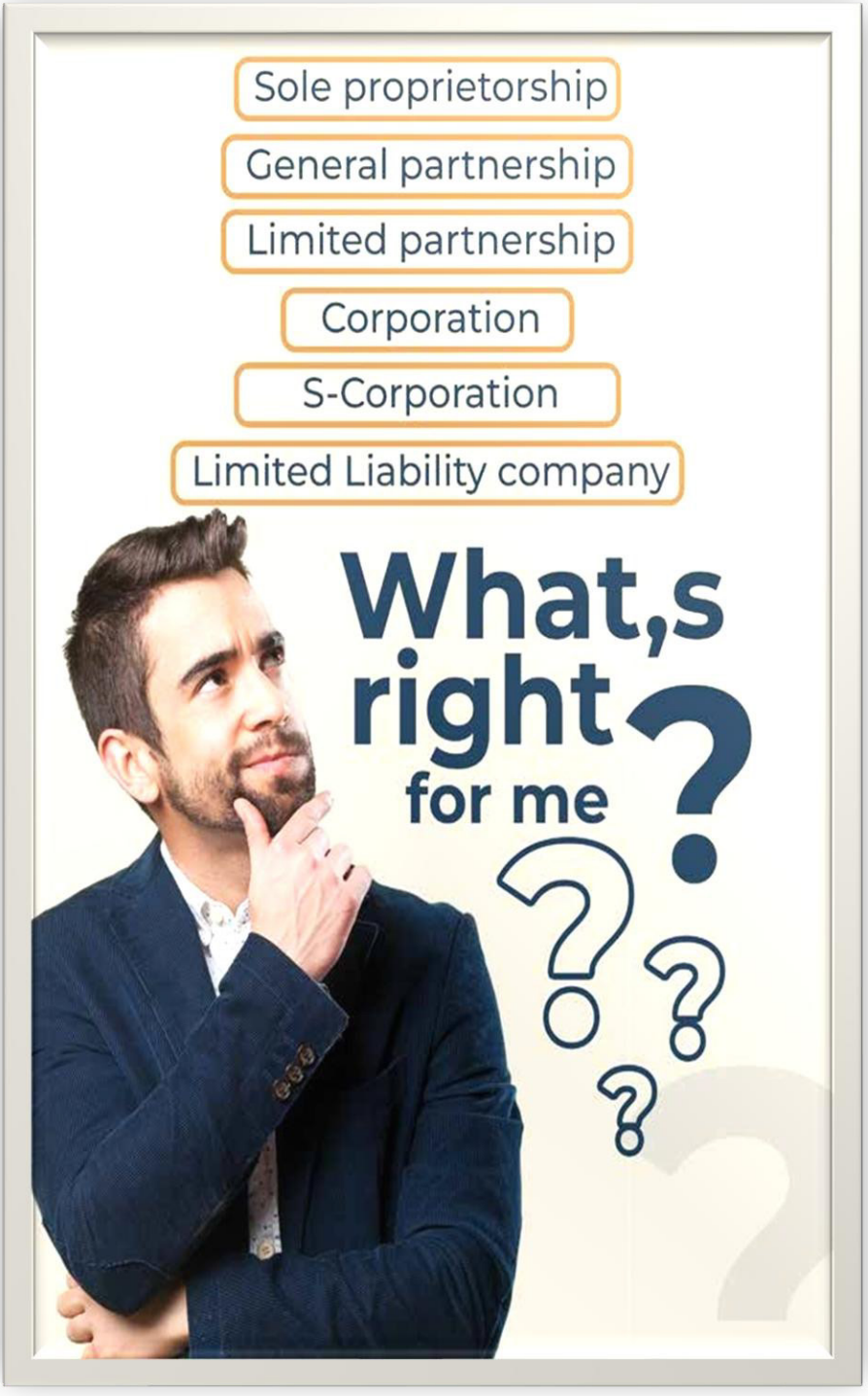
- Sole Proprietorship
- General Partnership
- Limited Partnership
- Corporation
- "S" Corporation
- Limited Liability Company (LLC)

Laws That May Affect You

- Income tax returns
- Franchise tax returns
- Employment tax returns
- The time for payment of withheld and employers share of employment taxes
- Unemployment tax returns and payment
- Sales tax reports and payments

How Can Your Professionals Help You?

- Attorney
- Accountant
- Payroll Service Providers
- Your pension plan manager


Sole proprietorship
General partnership
Limited partnership
Corporation
S-Corporation
Limited Liability company
What,s right for me ?

5. Licenses and Permits for Your Business

Choose a suitable name for your business and find out what licenses and permits you may require and how to get them.

FIRST THINGS FIRST

Licenses & Permits

- Local Licenses and Permits
- State Licenses and Permits
- Federal Licenses and Permits
- Where do I go to get a license?
- How about if you are working from home?

Business Name or DBA (Doing Business As)

- Do I need to have a DBA?
- What are the benefits to establishing a DBA?
- What is the process of getting a DBA?
- Banking Under Your Business Name
- Should I Trademark my Business Name?

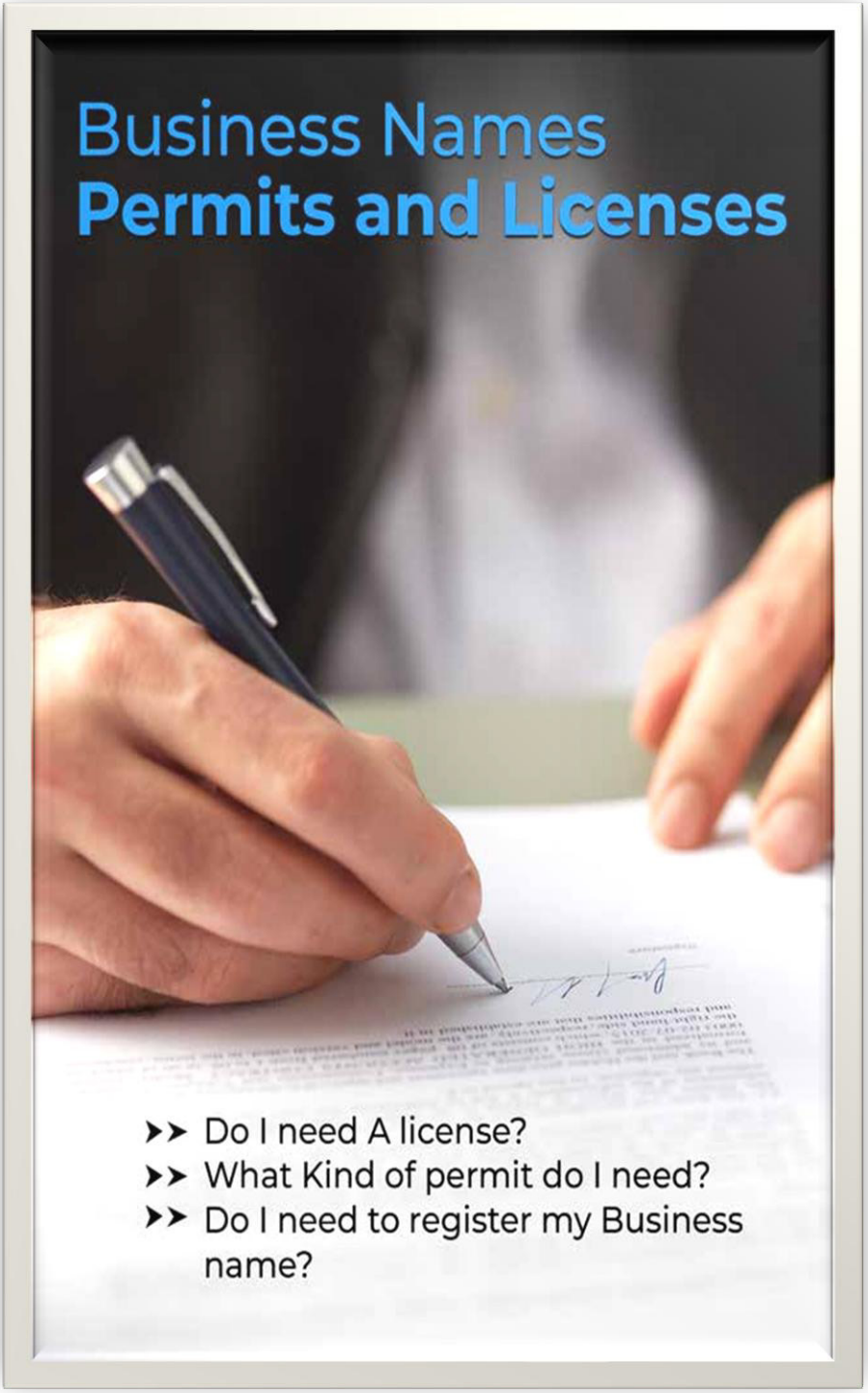
Seller's Permit

- What is a seller's permit?
- Where do I get a seller's permit?

Employer Identification Number (EIN)

- What is the importance of EIN?
- Do I need an EIN (Employer Identification Number)?
- Confirm whether an EIN is required:
- How do I apply for an EIN?
- How to apply ‘Online”

Business License and Permits Checklist


Business Names
Permits and Licenses
Do I need A license?
What Kind of permit do I need?
Do I need to register my Business name?

6. Business Insurance

The following will explain in simple terms the various forms of insurance you may need and explain the importance of each of them.

Insurance Coverage for Businesses

- Business Property Insurance
- General Liability Insurance
- Workers' Compensation Insurance
- Key-Man" Insurance Coverage
- Excess Liability Coverage
- Employment Practices Liability Coverage
- Forms of Life Insurance



7. Communication Tools

Communication is key to any business success! The following reviews basic communication and equipment aspects of business.

Types of Communication

- External
- Internal

Basic Communication Tools

- Landline Telephones
- Cell phones and Artificial Intelligence (AI)
- Smartphones
- Video and Web Conferencing
- Social networking sites
- Online chat tools
- Tele-Fax Systems

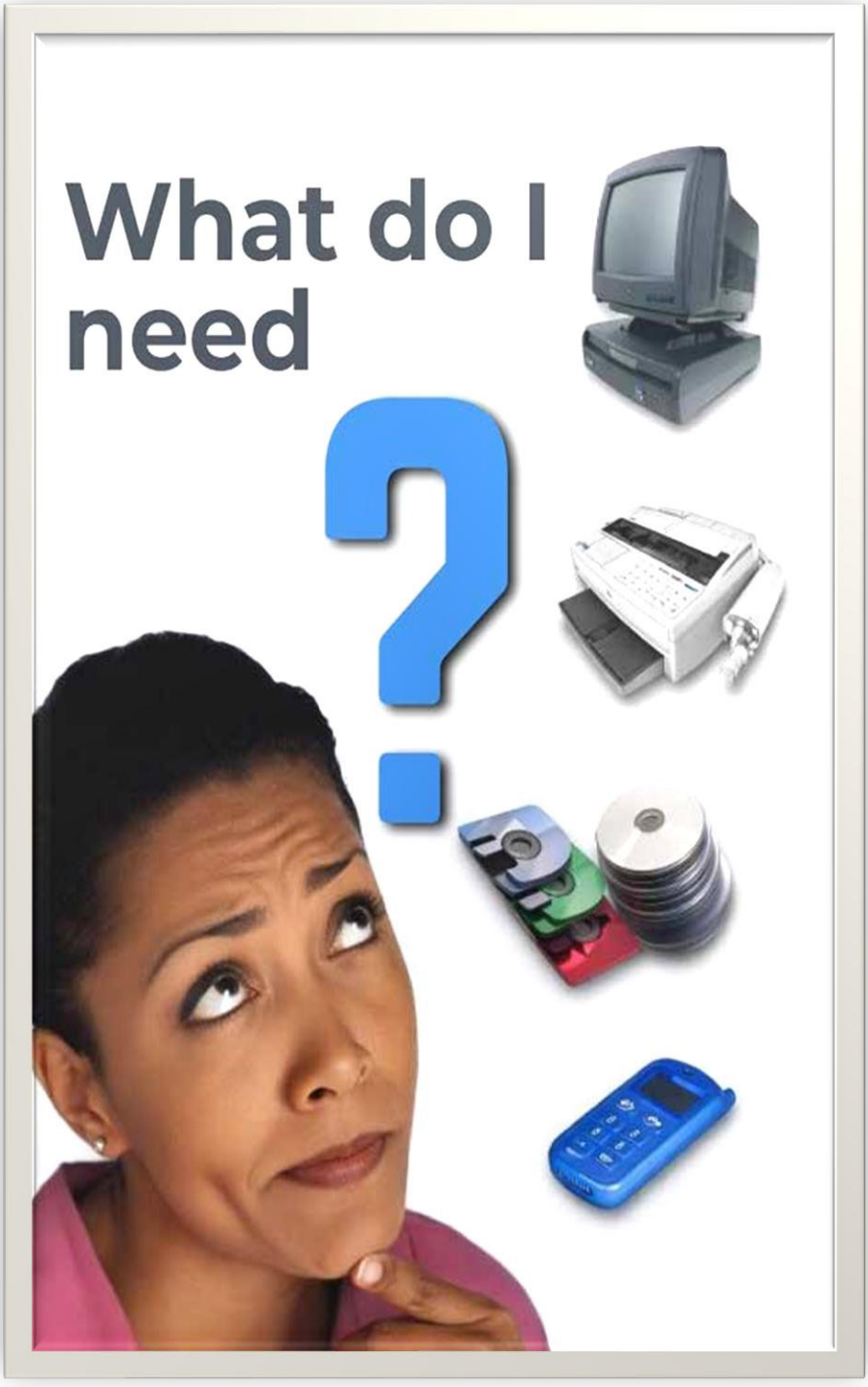
Computers

- Desktop
- Laptop
- Notebooks/Netbooks
- Tablet
- Handheld
- Software
- Auxiliary Products

Internet

- Browsers
- Feasibility and specifics
- Internet service provider
- E-mail

Technology Planning


What do I need

8. Buying a Business or Franchise

How to make objective decisions when considering the purchase of a business or a franchise and how to evaluate how much you should pay.

How Should I Go About Buying a Business?

- Opportunities
- Financial ability
- Evaluating a business
- How to determine a business' worth
- Sources of business financing
- Other factors to consider in determining value
- How to verify revenue and receivables information
- Buying an existing business VS buying a new business

Pros and Cons of Buying a Franchise

- Pros and Cons of buying a franchise
- What I should know about a prospective franchiser
- Becoming a franchiser
- No Equity (Ownership) in Franchise Business

Suggested Activities

- Visit different operations
- Attend trade shows
- Understand your intended business

Analyze any appropriate existing business

- Analyze a franchised operation


Buy
Or Go ?
My Way

PART THREE: Operating Pitfalls

9. Location and Leasing

A wonderful business can be crippled by a poor location or a poorly negotiated lease. You will learn how to create your own site model and the important aspects of a lease agreement.

Location, Location, Location

- Zoning Categories
- Criteria for Home-BasedBusiness
- Criteria for Manufacturing, Warehousing, or Industrial Business

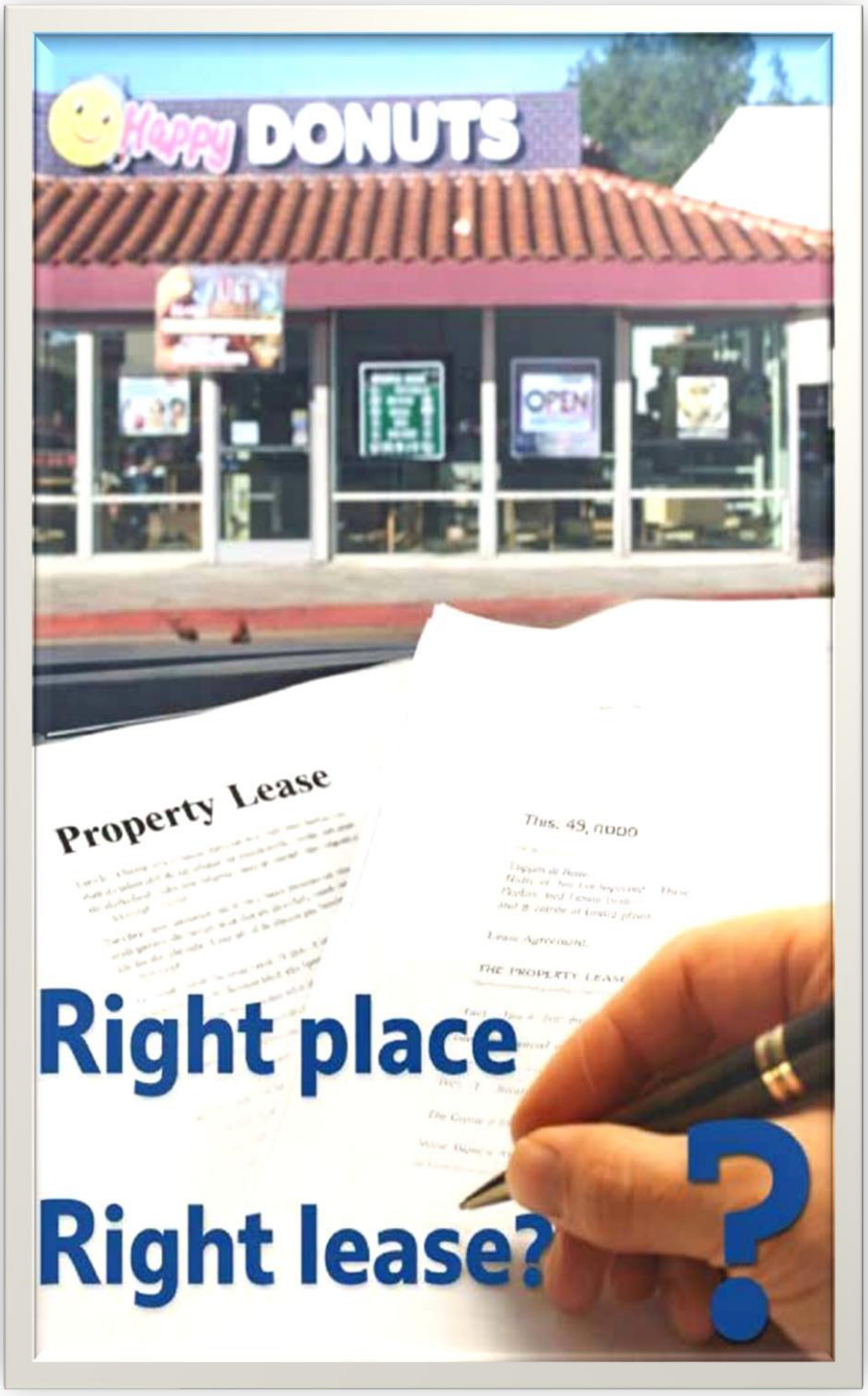
Leasing Checklist

- Points to Consider Before Signing a Lease or Purchasing Property
- Basic Lease Provisions
- Lease Check-Off List
- Rent or to Buy Considerations

Do Your Homework

Site Location Criteria

- Evaluation Table


Happy DONUTS
OPEN
Property Lease
Right place
Right lease?

10. Accounting and Cash Flow

Before you start your business, you will need to learn cash in your bank account (cash flow control). The following provides outline in simple terms and considerations.

Step One: Gain the appropriate knowledge

Step Two: Select an Accountant

Methods of Accounting

- Cash Basis Method
- Accrual Method
- Keeping Separate Business Records
- Tax Liability Issues
- Income Taxes
- Payroll Taxes
- Financial and Technical Assistance
- Internal Controls
- Quarterly Returns
- Bank Account Reconciliation
- Employee Benefits Policies

Step Three: Do your own Bookkeeping

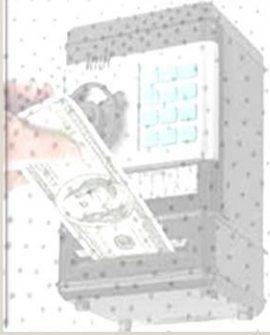
The Three Major Financial Statements

- The Balance Sheet
- The Income Statement Settlement (Profit & Loss)
- Cash Flow Control
- Accounting and Cash Flow Punch List



Who's Keeping $core ?





11. E-Commerce

E-Commerce is the fastest growing segment of our economy. It allows even the smallest business to reach a global audience with its product or message at minimal cost.

E-Commerce Overview

- What is E-Commerce?
- Is an E-Commerce website right for your business?

Money Transactions

- E-Commerce Considerations
- Alternative methods of online payments
- Money transactions summary

Setting Up a Website

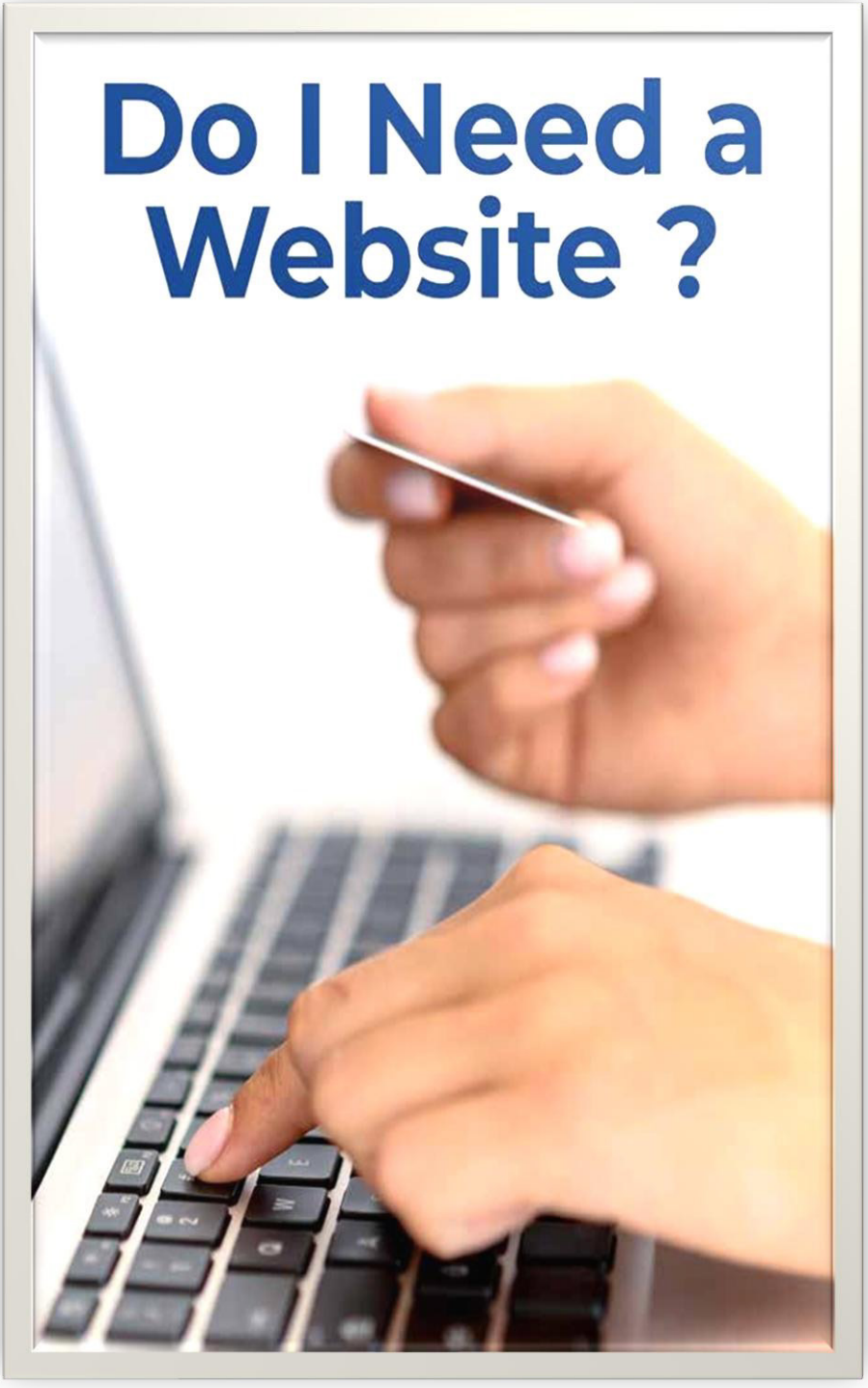
- Registering your domain name
- Hosting your website
- Building your website
- Hiring a professional website developer
- Designing your own website

Tips for Developing a Successful Site

- Make your site easy to use
- Provide useful content
- Encourage customer feedback
- Develop a mailing list

Online Marketing and Promotion

- Search engines - your primary marketing tool
- How does your website rank?
- For what are people searching?
- How to manage search engine placement
- Key components to successful search engine marketing for a website
- Search Engines and Resources
- Targeted E-Mail


Do I Need a
Website ?

12. Opening and Marketing (Branding)

You are furnished with check-off lists to maximize your marketing results and avoid the most common mistakes.

Opening for Business

BEFORE YOU "START CHECK LIST"

Marketing

Identify your Marketing Segmentation (Geographics)

- Pinpoint your customers (Demographics)
- Recruit the "right" employees
- Train your employees thoroughly in marketing skills
- Check list for hiring and training of your marketing team
- What and how to buy (Inventory)
- How to buy checklist
- Marketing tools
- E-commerce
- Promotion and Advertising (Branding)
- Mailing lists (Geographics)

Most Common Mistakes

- Make Checklist to avoid pitfalls



13. Managing Employees – Full Time; Part Time; & Contract Staff

It is not possible in this learning to include all the complexities and legal rules pertaining to employees. Since employees play such a significant role in achieving success, we recommend you maintain ongoing access to a labor lawyer to keep you current on labor matters including employing and terminating employees. It is better to avoid mistakes by securing legal advice before labor issues or claims are raised than to deal with expensive legal consequences later.

Step One: Before You Start

- Are you hiring an employee or independent contractor?
- Retain a payroll service provider or a professional employer organization
- Have job descriptions in place
- Have a benefits package in place
- Determine overall costs of new employees
- Create an employee handbook

Step Two: Hiring Employees

- Attracting applicant Interviewing practices
- Drug screening
- Americans with Disabilities Act
- Understanding workplace harassment
- Prevention of workplace violence
- Employment eligibility verification
- Selecting outstanding employees
- Legal considerations

Step Three: Create Training Disciplines

- Indoctrination
- Growing employee skills

Keeping Good Employees

- Importance of retention
- How to retain good employees


Managing
Employees
NOW
HIRING
CALL US TODAY
TO APPLY
000-000-0000
YOUR COMPANY
NAME HERE

14. Expanding and Handling Problems

A growing business needs to have appropriate expansion policies in place, plans to motivate key employees, and expertise in handling common business problems.

Here is the advice from "been-there-done-that" experts.

Rules to Follow Before Expanding

Starting with a Pilot Operation First

Problems in Expanded Business not Present in a Startup

- Delegation of responsibility and authority
- Monetary incentive plans

Ways to Motivate Key Employees

- Leveraged profit sharing plan
- Unleveraged profit-sharing plan
- Commission plan

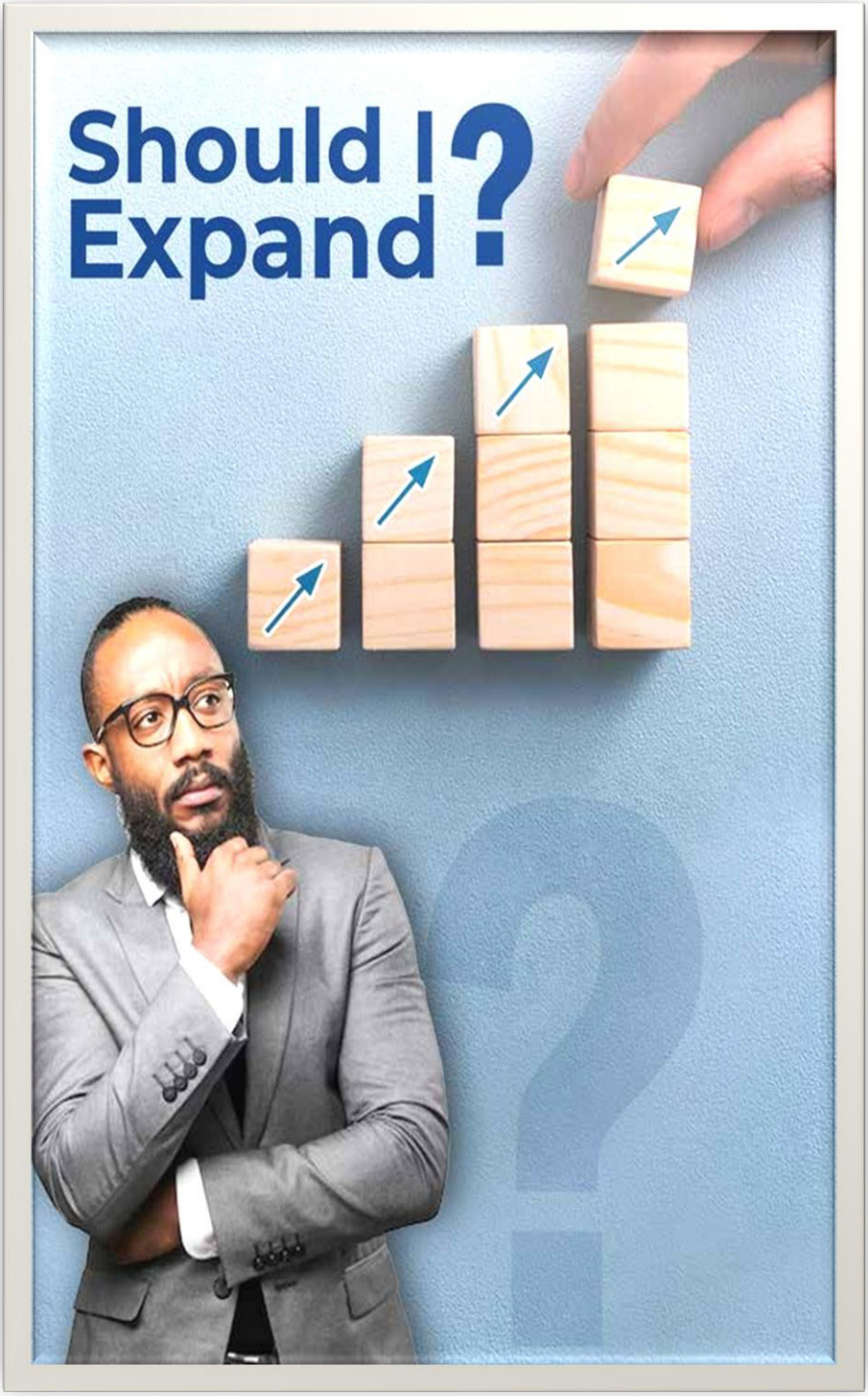
Key Elements for Profit Centers

Important Overall Considerations in Starting Your Business

- Pitfalls to avoid
- Long-range financial planning

Common Business Problems

- Uncontrolled cash flow
- Drop in sales or insufficient sales
- Higher costs
- New competition
- Business recession
- Incompetent managers or employees
- Dishonesty and theft


Should I
Expand ?

PART FOUR : Phenomenal Four Principles

15. Handling Human Relations Variables

A. Problem Solving

- Identify the problem
- Analyze its causes
- Propose two solutions
- Implement the better solution

B. Conflict Management

- Avoid the issue
- Make an effort to smooth the issue
- Compromise with individuals involved
- Confront the issue directly

C. Group Development

- Forming (With two or more individuals)
- Storming period (Restoring order)
- Norming segment (Building relations)
- Performing process (Establishing values)

D. Self-Disclosure

- Open Segment
- Closed Segment
- Hidden Segment
- Unknown Segment

E. Communication

- Input (Message Sender)
- Encoder (Message Receiver)
- Feedback (From Message Receiver)
- Decoder (To Message Sender)


On Your Mark
Get Set
Go!



"Taking on the challenge of starting, operating and managing a business is an experience that requires time, patience and the willingness to learn and apply the "right" Business Skills and Principles."

Jeffield Jefferson, MBA

Retired Executive Manager


Be Remarkable . . .
Always Maintain Excellent Health Habits

Starman's Business Guide



Starman’s Business Guide



Starman's Business Guide Narrative Section provides a brief summation of each of the 15 outlined sections of the guide. For each "Outlined" category, the "Narrative" section offers a brief, specific description and explanation. The narrative provides a simple and brief overview that aids the reader in understanding the purpose and objective of the Business Guide.



Part One through Part Four

The following Narrative Section provides the Reading Text to Starman's Business Guide. Each Numeric Segment correlates to the Sub-Titles in the Outline Context of the Business Guide's 15 outlined components.

PART ONE: Evaluating the Business

1. Deciding on a Business

The most common serious mistake made in business is not picking the right one to begin with. To avoid this, use important evaluation techniques to guide your decision. Begin by considering whether you genuinely want to be in business. Then, decide what type of business and the best location for your venture.

Consider whether you should start full-time or moonlight. Develop a selection strategy and identify things to watch out for, particularly if you are in transition. List the required activities, complete a comparative evaluation of pros and cons, and carefully evaluate any specif ic business you have in mind.

Be sure to develop a list of arguments for and against your choice and work to become completely qualified to operate the business. Confirm your decision when you are ready.

2. Formatting and Developing Your Business Plan

A business plan is a key ingredient for success and is often overlooked. This overview explains how to create an individualized business plan and provides tools to make the process easier. Understand what a business plan is and why you should prepare one. Avoid common pitfalls when creating your plan.

The format should include a mission and vision statement, selection of your management team, and the development of a business profile. Make an economic assessment and follow six steps to a great business plan: outline the basic business concept in your executive summary, ensure following six steps to a great business plan: Outline the basic business concept in your executive summary, ensure feasibility and specif ics, refine your business concept, outline the business details, present your plan compellingly, and review sample plans. Your plan should summarize a sound business concept, demonstrate an understanding of your market, show that you are in a healthy, growing, and stable industry, include capable management, provide for financial control, and maintain a consistent business focus.

Anticipate change, make plans for your online business, and be ready to formulate and reformulate your business plan. Review an actual business plan and corporate articles of incorporation for reference.

PART TWO: Before You Start

3. Financing the Business

Follow steps to locate, negotiate and maintain sources of money to start and expand your business. First, determine how much money you need and for what it will be used. Consider whether you require unsecured or secured loans and if you have enough collateral.

Understand the difference between loans (debt) and investments (equity) and identify where to get the money. Review several types of funding sources and use a lender comparison table. Master the art of getting money by understanding business loans, planning repayments, and using other quick tips. Remember to manage your finances effectively after receiving funding.

4. Business Organization

Choose the form of business that is right for you by considering key decisions. Decide whether to go into business alone or with a partner and select the appropriate type of business organization: sole proprietorship, partnership, corporation, or limited liability company (LLC). Seek advice from professional advisors such as attorneys, accountants, payroll service providers and pension plan managers. Consider the arguments for and against having a partner.

Review the pros and cons of each business structure, including sole proprietorship, general partnership, limited partnership, corporation, “S” corporation and LLC. Be aware of laws affecting you, such as income, franchise, employment, unemployment, and sales tax returns and payments. Know how professionals can assist you with these requirements.

5. Licenses and Permits for Your Business

Choose a suitable name for your business and research the licenses and permits you may need. Obtain local, state and federal licenses and permits and know where to go to get them. This is important even for home-based businesses.

Decide if you need a DBA ("Doing Business As"), understand its benefits, and learn the process of obtaining one. Establish banking under your business name and consider trademarking it. If your business requires a seller's permit, find out where to acquire it.

Learn the importance of an Employer Identification Number (EIN), determine if you need one and follow the steps to apply, including how to apply online. Use a business license and permit checklist to stay organized.

6. Business Insurance

Understand the various forms of insurance needed to protect your business. Business property insurance, general liability insurance, and workers' compensation insurance are essential. Consider “key-man” insurance coverage, excess liability coverage and employment practices liability coverage. Review the forms of life insurance that may be applicable to your business.

7. Communication Tools

Effective communication is crucial to business success. Review the types of communication, both external and internal and the basic communication tools available. These include landline telephones, cell phones, artificial intelligence-enabled devices, smartphones, video and web conferencing, social networking sites, online chat tools and telefax systems.

For computing needs, explore desktops, laptops, notebooks/netbooks, tablets, handheld devices, software and auxiliary products. Understand internet-related tools such as browsers, internet service providers and e-mail. Plan your technological needs carefully.

8. Buying a Business or Franchise

Make objective decisions when considering the purchase of a business or franchise. Assess opportunities and your financial ability. Evaluate the business and determine its worth. Explore sources of business financing and other factors that contribute to value. Verify revenue and receivables information.

Weigh the pros and cons of buying an existing business versus a new one. Consider the pros and cons of buying a franchise, what you should know about prospective franchisers and the implications of becoming a franchiser, including the lack of equity in franchise business. Engage in suggested activities such as visiting different operations, attending trade shows, understanding your intended business and analyzing both existing and franchised operations.

PART THREE: Operating Pitfalls

9. Location and Leasing

A good business can be undermined by a poor location or an unfavorable lease. Learn to create a site model and understand important aspects of lease agreements. Consider zoning categories and criteria for home-based, manufacturing, warehousing, industrial or retail businesses.

Use a leasing checklist to review points before signing or purchasing property, including basic lease provisions and rent versus buy considerations. Conduct thorough research using site location criteria and evaluation tables.

10. Accounting and Cash Flow

Before you start your business, you will need to learn cash if your bank account (cash flow control). The following provides an outline in simple terms and considerations.

Methods of Accounting

- Cash Basis Method
- Accrual Method

Strong cash flow management is essential to launching and sustaining a successful business. The following steps outline the core knowledge and practices you should establish early on.

Step One: Build Foundational Knowledge

Develop a working understanding of cash flow control and basic accounting principles to support informed financial decision making.

Step Two: Select a Qualified Accountant

Engage a professional accountant who can guide you on appropriate accounting methods and ensure compliance with tax and reporting requirements.

Key Accounting Considerations

Methods of Accounting:

Before you start your business, you will need to learn cash in your bank account (cash flow control). The following provides outline in simple terms and considerations.

Cash Basis Method
Actual Method

- Maintain separate financial records for your business
- Understand income and payroll tax obligations
- Establish internal financial controls
- File required quarterly tax returns
- Perform regular bank reconciliations
- Implement employee benefits policies

Step Three: Manage Your Own Bookkeeping

Become familiar with the three primary financial statements, which serve as the foundation for monitoring your company's financial health:

These tools will help you maintain clear oversight of your finances and support long-term business stability.

- Keeping Separate Business Records
- Tax Liability Issues
- Income Taxes
- Payroll Taxes
- Financial and Technical Assistance
- Internal Controls
- Quarterly Returns
- Bank Account Reconciliation
- Employee Benefits Policies

The Three Major Financial Statements

- The Balance Sheet
- The Income Statement Settlement (Profit & Loss)
- Cash Flow Control

11. E-Commerce

E-commerce is a rapidly growing segment, offering businesses the opportunity to reach global audiences at minimal cost.

Learn what e-commerce is and decide if an e-commerce website is right for your business. Consider money transactions, alternative online payment methods, and transaction summaries. Set up your website by registering a domain, hosting, building, and deciding whether to hire a professional developer or design it yourself.

Develop a successful site by making it easy to use, providing useful content, encouraging customer feedback, and building a mailing list. Promote your site online using search engines, understanding ranking and search behavior, and managing search engine placement. Key components to success include targeted marketing and audience engagement.

Additional e-commerce considerations include targeted e-mail campaigns and utilizing resources such as eBay. Learn how to get started with eBay, understand listing basics and fees, and maximize your experience by following best practices and avoiding common pitfalls.

12. Opening and Marketing (Branding)

Use check-off lists to maximize marketing results and avoid common mistakes when opening your business. Before you start, verify that all necessary steps are completed. In marketing, identify your segmentation and pinpoint your customers using demographics. Recruit and thoroughly train the right employees in marketing skills.

Use hiring and training checklists for your marketing team. Learn what to buy, how to buy, and use marketing tools, including e-commerce, promotion, and advertising. Build and use mailing lists based on geographic segmentation. Create checklists to avoid marketing pitfalls.

13. Managing Employees: Full Time, Part Time & Contract Staff

While it is not possible to include all complexities and legal rules related to employees here, remember that employees are critical to business success. Maintain ongoing access to a labor lawyer to stay current on labor matters, including hiring and firing employees, and seek legal advice before labor issues arise to avoid costly consequences.

Before hiring, determine whether you will employ staff or use independent contractors. Retain a payroll service provider or professional employer organization, prepare job descriptions, and offer a benefits package. Calculate the overall costs of new employees and create an employee handbook.

During the hiring process, focus on attracting applicants, using effective interviewing practices, conducting drug screening, complying with the Americans with Disabilities Act, understanding workplace harassment, preventing workplace violence, and verifying employment eligibility. Select outstanding employees and address legal considerations.

After hiring, establish training disciplines, including indoctrination and skills development. To keep good employees, prioritize retention and implement strategies to retain talent. Develop a Succession Plan.

14. Expanding and Handling Problems

As your business grows, implement expansion policies and plans to motivate key employees and prepare to manage common business problems. Experts recommend starting with a pilot operation before full expansion. Be aware that expanded businesses may face challenges not present in startups, such as delegation of responsibility and authority, and developing monetary incentive plans.

Motivate key employees with leveraged and unleveraged profit-sharing plans, commission plans, and other incentives. Focus on key elements for profit centers and consider crucial factors for starting your business, including pitfalls to avoid and the importance of long-range financial planning.

Prepare for common business problems such as uncontrolled cash flow, drops or insufficiency in sales, higher costs, new competition, business recessions, incompetent managers or employees, and dishonesty or theft.

PART FOUR: Phenomenal Four Principles

15. Handling Human Relations Variables

A. **Problem Solving**

- Identify the problem
- Analyze its causes
- Propose at least two solutions
- Implement the better solution.

B. **Conflict Management**

- Avoid the issue (if plausible)
- Make an effort to smooth the issue
- Compromise with individuals involved
- Confront the issue directly

C. **Group Development**

- Forming (two or more individuals)
- Storming Period (restoring order)
- Norming Segment (Building relations)
- Performing process (Establishing values)

Author's End Notes

Organizational and Structural Designations

A. Types of Business Organizational Structures
   1. Product (Producer) 2. Service (Servicer) 3. Matrix (Term)

B. Types of Business Classifications
   1. Sole Proprietor 2. Partnerships 3. Corporations 4. LLC

C. Standard Business Units of Business Organizations
   1. Department 2. Division 3. Section 4. Team 5..Crews

D. Standard Department Classifications
   1. Administration 2. Operations 3. Marketing 4. Finance

E. Organization Chart - Executive Level & Descending
   1. Vertical 2. Horizontal 3. Supervisory 4. Entry Level

F. Standard Managerial Skills (Mandatory) and Abilities
   1. Organizer 2. Planner 3. Staffer 4. Actuator 5. Control

G. Phenomenal Four (4) Principles of Human Relations Skills
   1. Group Development 2. Problem Solving
   3. Conflict Management 4. Communication 5. Self- Disclosure

I. The Ingredients of a "SUCCESS" Type Personality (Not Shown)

J. 1. Mission Statement 2. Vision Statement 3. Plans 4. Systems
   5. Strategies 6. Schedules 7. Implementation 8. Execution